together: you can use them to migrate existing on-premises infrastructures or build from scratch. The pricing model for services is pay-per-use.

As an AWS customer, you can choose among different *data centers*. AWS data centers are distributed worldwide. For example, you can start a virtual machine in Japan in exactly the same way as you would start one in Ireland. This enables you to serve customers worldwide.

The map in figure 1.1 shows AWS's data centers. Access to some of them is limited: some data centers are accessible for US government organizations only, and special conditions apply for the data centers in China. Additional data centers have been announced for Canada, Spain, Switzerland, Israel, UAE, India, Australia, and New Zealand.



Figure 1.1 AWS data center locations

Now that we have defined the most important terms, the question is: what can you do with AWS?